

2010 02 22 Study Session

LAKEWOOD CITY COUNCIL STUDY SESSION MINUTES

Monday, February 22, 2010
City of Lakewood
City Council Chambers
6000 Main Street SW
Lakewood, WA 98499

CALL TO ORDER

Mayor Richardson called the meeting to order at 7:02 p.m.

ROLL CALL

Councilmembers Present: 7 ? Mayor Douglas Richardson; Deputy Mayor Don Anderson; Councilmembers Mary Moss, Mike Brandstetter, Jason Whalen, Walter Neary and Claudia Thomas.

ITEMS FOR DISCUSSION:

Review of the proposed Driving With License Suspended Program.

Officer Scott Novasky and Assistant City Attorney Mike McKenzie reviewed the proposed driving with license suspended program with regard to towing of vehicles.

Discussion ensued relative to retaining a vehicle for those without insurance; how many vehicles would be impounded if this ordinance was adopted and how would it impact Court and Police staff; why did Lakewood not implement this earlier and why the State Patrol no longer implements this program; possibly changing the proposed ordinance from ?posting a five-day notice? to ?five days from receipt? of the notice before the sale of the vehicle at auction; what is the priority order of recouping the costs for removal, towing and storage; how difficult is it to obtain an occupational driving license; what strategy would be used to inform the public; and the option to impose this program for driving with license suspended for second and third degree offenses only.

Speaking before the Council was:

Dennis Haugen, Lakewood resident, spoke in support of the proposed driving with license suspended program.

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Council and members of the audience congratulated Councilmember Moss and sang happy birthday.

Council recessed at 8:10 p.m. and reconvened at 8:30 p.m.

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Review of the Five Year FY 2010-2015 Consolidated Plan, FY 2010 Annual Action Plan and FY 2007 and FY 2008 Consolidated Plan amendments and the proposed use of funds for CDBG and HOME.

Program Grants Coordinator Gumm provided background information about the Five-Year Consolidated Plan and proposed FY 2010 Annual Action Plan and proposed amendments to the FY 2007 and FY 2008 Consolidated Plans.

Consultant Linda Rinaldi provided an overview of the Five-Year Consolidated Plan, defining strategies for the next five years. She then reviewed the population and economy data, and housing needs and affordability.

Consultant John Epler reviewed the homeless count and needs. He then reviewed Lakewood's goals based on the U.S. Department of Housing and Urban Development's national objectives which were similar to Tacoma's goals who Lakewood partners with in the HOME Consortium.

Discussion ensued on the value of the Five-Year Plan that will help Lakewood frame a long term strategy in meeting community needs.

Community Development Block Grant (CDBG) Citizens Advisory Board Chair Michael Lacadie reviewed the FY 2010 CDBG proposed use of funds based on the funding priorities of the Council.

Discussion ensued on what the CDBG Citizens Advisory Board's recommendation would be if the Council did not adopt a small business loan program and if funding could be used for side sewer Tillicum hook-ups for businesses. If the Council were to ask for another alternative for economic development, how long would it take the CDBG Citizens Advisory Board to come back with other recommended options.

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Speaking before the Council was:

Dennis Haugen, Lakewood resident, spoke about the City not being able to afford the administration of the CDBG program.

BRIEFING BY THE CITY MANAGER

City Manager Neiditz reminded the Council of joint meetings with the Citizens Advisory Boards and Committees.

City Manager Neiditz reported that interviews will be held for the Court Administrator position.

City Manager Neiditz reported that a training "burn" on a City-owned property on Pacific Highway will be conducted by the Fire Department on February 24, 2010.

A volunteer workshop, "Pain behind the badge," sponsored by the Police Department was held last week.

City Manager Neiditz indicated that the National Law Enforcement memorial will be held in May and that he is planning to honor the request for the families of the four fallen officers, and the officers and honor guards who escorted the families, to attend the memorial in Washington, D.C.

City Manager Neiditz reported that the Lakewood Water District is requesting that the City maintain over 1,900 hydrants at the cost of \$100 per hydrant, amounting to approximately \$195,000 annually.

City Manager Neiditz spoke about reducing \$500,000 of General Funding spending in 2010 by eliminating a couple of positions in administration and Community Development, cutting back on professional services, computer expenditures, reducing Public Works spending, and the vehicle replacement fund and, with the four vacancies in the Police Department, two of the four positions would continue with hiring and the remaining two will be delayed until the third quarter of 2010.

Deputy Mayor Anderson suggested that the City engage in a discussion with the Fire District, Lakewood Water District and the City relative to the maintenance costs of fire hydrants.

Councilmember Neary asked for a list of the budget reductions and their amounts. He then expressed concern about the delayed hiring of two police officers.

Mayor Richardson asked if furloughs were considered.

City Manager Neiditz commented that a meeting was held with the Washington State Department of Transportation (WSDOT) and senior staff from the Rail Department. He added that there was also discussion with the Utilities Transportation Commission (UTC) and that, of the seven rail crossings, four involves the Sounder Service. He indicated that the UTC would hold a public hearing and that there would be a vehicle for discussion rather than outright litigation. He explained that the WSDOT indicated that they need to do more public outreach in Lakewood.

ITEM TENTATIVELY SCHEDULED FOR THE MARCH 1, 2010 REGULAR CITY COUNCIL MEETING:

1. Review of the proposed Driving With License Suspended Program. ? (Ordinance ? Regular Agenda)

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CITY COUNCIL COMMENTS

Councilmember Neary spoke about the upcoming Citizens Transportation Committee meeting on February 23, 2010 where WSDOT will be doing a presentation.

Councilmember Thomas congratulated City Manager Neiditz for being elected as the International City Management Association West Coast Regional Vice President.

Councilmember Brandstetter thanked the Council for their involvement at the Pierce County Regional Council (PCRC) assembly and the Caring for Kids event. He asked for an update on providing support of the military brigade that the Council discussed at their retreat.

Councilmember Whalen reported that at the PCRC meeting, the Council was successful in reprogramming \$192,000 of funds for Lakewood. He then asked for a periodic economic development update on Pacific Highway.

Deputy Mayor Anderson spoke about being proactive with Lakewood's top sales taxpayers in the City and to approach them about how the City can help them sustain and expand their businesses.

Councilmember Brandstetter asked what the City could do to help the businesses who experience a tragic loss such as a fire to help them restart their businesses.

Mayor Richardson spoke about the Lakewood Elks Club dinner for the four fallen officers he attended.

ADJOURNMENT

There being no further business, the meeting adjourned at 9:30 p.m.

DOUGLAS G. RICHARDSON, MAYOR

ATTEST:

ALICE M. BUSH, MMC

CITY CLERK